

Chapter 156

Resolve FX Color

These plugins provide color processing methods that aren't available in any of the Color Page palettes of the Color page and include several color management tools that can be applied outside of Resolve Color Management (RCM).

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ACES Transform

Lets you perform the kind of color transforms that the ACES Input Device Transform and ACES Output Device Transform parameters of the Color Management panel do, without the need to have ACEScc or ACEScct enabled.

- **ACES Version:** When you've chosen one of the ACES color science options, this pop-up becomes available to let you choose which version of ACES you want to use.
- **Input Transform:** This pop-up menu lets you choose which IDT (Input Device Transform) to use to process the image. It presents the same options that are available in the Color Management panel of the Project Settings.
- **Output Transform:** This pop-up menu lets you choose an ODT (Output Device Transform) with which to transform the image data for monitoring on your calibrated display and when exporting a timeline in the Deliver page. It presents the same options that are available in the Color Management panel of the Project Settings.
- **Gamut Compress Type:** This lets you choose the type of ACES Gamut compression applied to the node. Choosing either option can prevent monochromatic highly saturated light sources (LEDs, neon signs, tail lights, etc.) from clipping the gamut.

For more information about the options available in these parameters, see *Chapter 9, "Data Levels, Color Management, and ACES."*

NOTE: This plugin does ACES transforms correctly using the transforms specified by the Academy, whereas the Color Transform plugin does transforms to the ACES color space colorimetrically, which is not actually correct for ACES workflows.

Chromatic Adaptation

A Color category plugin that lets you precisely transform an image that has been lit or processed assuming one specific color temperature to another user-selectable color temperature. This transformation alters the appearance of all colors in the image as perceived by the human vision system in the same way that a new illuminant would, whether that illuminant is a light in the environment being recorded or the color temperature of a display on which the image is shown. This plugin is useful for performing specific color temperature transformations as part of color management workflows or for setting up precise color temperature adjustments as part of a creative grade.

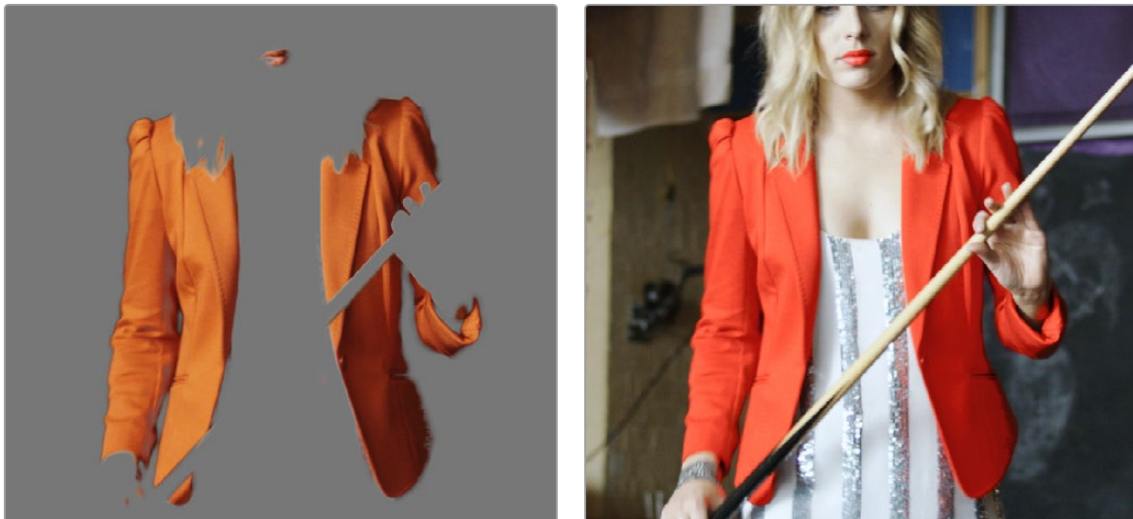
- **Method:** The Method pop-up menu provides a variety of different transform methods to choose from, defaulting to CAT02. Each option in the Method pop-up menu uses different measurement datasets to create individual CAT matrixes to guide this transformation. As a result, each method prioritizes different levels of accuracy for different sets of colors. For example:
 - CAT02 has a non-linear component that compensates for the tendency of extremely saturated blues to go purple, a typical weakness of other methods. It usually gives the best result for the widest variety of measured data sets and works best for emissive sources (displays) and dim viewing environments.
 - Bradford Linear is also a commonly used method, albeit one in which extremely saturated blues will go purple during the transform. It works well for both emissive sources in dim environments and for reflective sources (theater screens) and dark environments.

- Von Kries is one of the oldest methods in common use, although it's also one in which extremely saturated blues will go purple during the transform. This, as well as all other methods, are available if you need to match work done in another image processing application.
- **Source/Target Illuminant:** You control this transformation by using pop-up menus to define the Illuminant Type of the source (typically the color temperature the camera was set to), and that of the target that you want to transform the image to. For both sets of controls, you can choose a Standard Illuminant from a list, a Color Temperature via a slider, or CIE 1931 xy coordinate values. This image transform is extremely precise because the image is first transformed from the Timeline Color Space to XYZ, and then it's transformed to match the LMS (long, medium, short) color space that models the cone response of the human eye to colors lit by different illuminants.
- **Current Color Space and Gamma:** This plugin also takes into account the current color space and gamma of the clip, which default to those set for the current timeline. If you wish to change these values, you can do so using the Color Space and Gamma menus.

NOTE: Be aware that all methods listed will match neutral colors perfectly; the only differences lie in how different ranges of saturated color are transformed.

Color Compressor (Studio Version Only)

This filter lets you compress a range of colors toward a single target color. It works best when applied to similarly colored regions that have been isolated with a secondary qualifier or window. For example, if you're adjusting an irregularly lit product such as a soda can or a dress that must have a very specific hue, you can isolate that item and use this filter to push the range of Hue, Saturation, and Luminance closer to the target color that's identified using the color picker.



(Before/After) Using the Color Compressor plugin to compress original range of hues of the jacket into a narrow "target" range within a secondary operation

- **Target Color:** A color control that allows you to choose a specific color or sample a color from the image using the eyedropper. These selected color values are what you want to push all other colors toward.
- **Compress Hue, Compress Saturation, and Compress Luminance:** These sliders let you individually compress the range of colors you're adjusting in the image to more and more

closely match the image. At 0, no compression is applied, at 0.500 the original range of colors in the image have been adjusted to be halfway between their original values and the values of the Target Color, and at 1.000 the original range of colors has been set to be identical to the Target Color.

Color Space Transform

Lets you perform the kind of color transforms that LUTs do, but instead of using lookup tables, this plugin uses the same math used by Resolve Color Management (RCM) in order to do extremely clean color transforms without clipping.

Color Space Transform

Exposes four pop-up menus that let you set an Input Colorspace, Input Gamma, Output Colorspace, and Output Gamma, in order to do controlled transforms from the Input settings to the Output settings, right within a grade. Resolve Color Management does not have to be enabled for you to use this filter. The Swap button lets you quickly reverse the color and gamma space conversion.

Tone Mapping

Tone Mapping Method lets you enable tone mapping to accommodate workflows where you need to transform one color space into another with a dramatically larger or smaller dynamic range by automating an expansion or contraction of image contrast in such a way as to give a pleasing result with no clipping.

- **None:** This setting disables Input DRT Tone Mapping. No tone mapping is applied to the Input to Timeline Color Space conversion at all, resulting in a simple 1:1 mapping to the Timeline Color Space.
- **Clip:** Hard clips all out-of-bounds values.
- **Simple:** Uses a simple curve to perform this transformation, compressing or expanding the highlights and/or shadows of the timeline dynamic range to better fit the output dynamic range. Note that the “Simple” option maps between approximately 5500 nits and 100 nits, so if you’re mapping from an HDR source with more than 5500 nits to an SDR destination there may still be some clipping of the highlights above 5500 nits.
- **Luminance Mapping:** Same as DaVinci, but more accurate when the Input Color Space of all your media is in a single standards-based color space, such as Rec. 709 or Rec. 2020.
- **DaVinci:** This option tone maps the transform with a smooth luminance roll-off in the shadows and highlights, and controlled desaturation of image values in the very brightest and darkest parts of the image. This setting is particularly useful for wide-gamut camera media and is a good setting to use when mixing media from different cameras.
- **Saturation Preserving:** This option has a smooth luminance roll-off in the shadows and highlights, but does so without desaturating dark shadows and bright highlights, so this is an effective option for colorists who like to push color harder. However, because over-saturation in the highlights of the image can look unnatural, two parameters are exposed to provide some user-adjustable automated desaturation.

Sat. Rolloff Start: Lets you set a threshold, in nits (cd/m^2), at which saturation will roll off along with highlight luminance. Beginning of the rolloff.

Sat. Rolloff Limit: Lets you set a threshold, in nits (cd/m^2), at which the image will be totally desaturated. End of the rolloff.

- **Use Custom Max Input/Output:** Checking these boxes and adjusting the slider below allows you to specify the minimum and maximum luminance of the input image in nits. Using these two sliders together, you can set which value from the Input Gamma is mapped to which value of the Output Gamma.
- **Adaptation:** Used to compensate for large differences in the viewer's state of visual adaptation when viewing a bright image on an HDR display versus seeing that same image on an SDR display. For most "average" images this setting works best set between 0–10. However, when you're converting very bright images (for example, a snow scene at noon), then using a higher value will yield more image detail within the highlights.

Gamut Mapping

Gamut Mapping Method accommodates workflows where you need to transform one color space into another with a dramatically larger or smaller gamut by helping to automate an expansion or contraction of image saturation in such a way as to give a pleasing and naturalistic result with no clipping.

- Choosing None results in no Gamut mapping at all.
- Choosing Saturation Mapping from this menu enables saturation mapping to fit the range of saturation values from the Input Color Space and Gamma into the Output Color Space and Gamma. It enables the Saturation Knee and Saturation Max. controls.
 - The Saturation Knee slider sets the image level at which saturation mapping begins. Below this level, no remapping is applied. All saturation values from this level on up are remapped according to the Saturation Max. slider. A value of 1.0 is maximum saturation in the currently selected output color space.
 - The Saturation Max slider sets the new maximum level to which you want to either raise or lower all saturation values that are above the Saturation Knee setting. A value of 1.0 is maximum saturation in the currently selected output color space.
- Choosing "Clip" hard clips all out-of-gamut values.

NOTE: While this plugin has ACES settings, it does transforms to the ACES color space colormetrically, which is not actually correct for ACES workflows. For actual ACES workflows, use the ACES Transform plugin, which uses transforms specified by the Academy.

Advanced

This drop-down menu exposes the advanced features of the Color Space Transform effect.

- **Apply Forward OOTF:** Check this box to convert the image from scene referred to display referred color management.
- **Apply Inverse OOTF:** Check this box to convert the image from display referred to scene referred color management.
- **Use white point adaptation:** Applies a chromatic adaptation transform to account for different white points between color spaces.
 - Uncheck this box if you simply want to view the input color space's white point unaltered in the output color space. For example, wanting to use a P3-D60 mastered clip inside a P3-D65 timeline for reference purposes.
 - Check this box to apply the chromatic adaptation transform to convert the input white point to match the output color space's white point. For example, wanting a P3-D60 mastered clip to cut in with other clips mastered in a P3-D65 timeline.

Color Stabilizer (Studio Version Only)

Designed to deal with clips that have inconsistencies in exposure and color, caused by manual changes to a lens' aperture setting or by a camera's auto exposure and white balance settings causing unwanted changes to color and brightness in the middle of a shot. The Color Stabilizer plugin analyzes a frame of the clip that represents the desired exposure and color, and automatically adjusts every other frame of the current clip to match the analyzed levels.

IMPORTANT: The Color Stabilizer gives you the best results with clips that don't have clipped highlights. When used in the Color page, it's recommended to grade the image to bring all the highlights you want somewhere at or under a value of 1023, and then apply the Color Stabilizer to a node after this adjustment.

You will want to use the Color Stabilizer before grading the image. Grading before using the Color Stabilizer can give you unpredictable results.

There are two ways of using the Color Stabilizer:

- The easiest way is to choose Entire Frame from the Region of Analysis pop-up menu. Then, move the playhead in the Viewer to the frame that represents the contrast and color you want the entire clip to have, and click the Live Region Analysis button. Now, if you play through the clip, changes in contrast and color should be gone. This method works best for clips where the inconsistency you're trying to eliminate affects the entire picture.
- Another way is to choose Selected Area from the Region of Analysis pop-up menu. This causes an onscreen rectangle to appear that you can resize and position over a specific region you want to sample for the duration of the clip. If the selected feature you're analyzing is moving, then you can use the FX Tracker to track the subject so the selection box follows it (this is important for a consistent result). Once this is set up, move the playhead in the Viewer to the frame that represents the contrast and color you want the entire clip to have, and click the Analyze This Frame.

Now, if you play through the clip, changes in contrast and color should be gone. This allows you to stabilize the color of the shot, even if dark objects move through the frame or the highlights change level. You can use the selection box to specifically analyze the part of the frame that has the unwanted exposure change, while ignoring the desirable exposure change.

Depending on what option you choose from the Region for Analysis pop-up menu, different additional options appear.

Analysis Region

If you choose "Selected Area" from the Region of Analysis pop-up, a rectangle in the Viewer appears and you can control its position, scale, and size by clicking and dragging on its corners in the Viewer. These on-screen controls let you transform the selection box that defines which part of the image is being analyzed.

Channels to Stabilize

Once you've analyzed the frame that represents the best contrast and color for that clip, the Channels to Stabilize controls let you choose how to make the correction. The What to Stabilize pop-up menu lets you choose between stabilizing White Balance and Brightness, or R, G, B Channels Separately.

- If you choose White Balance and Brightness, two checkboxes let you choose whether or not you want to include Stabilize White Balance and Stabilize Brightness independently from one another.
- If you choose R, G, B channels separately, three checkboxes appear letting for Stabilize Red, Green, and Blue Channel, so you can pick which particular channels you want to correct.

The Stabilize drop-down menu lets you choose how to make the correction, with the options Levels and Contrast, Offset, and Gain, each of which uses a different method to make the necessary correction, so if one method doesn't work for the particular problem your clip is exhibiting, you can try the other methods to try and get a better result.

Captured Analysis Values

Once you've analyzed the frame, another set of parameters appear showing the captured analysis values upon which the automated correction is based, so that you can make manual adjustments if necessary to improve the result. The parameters that are shown depend on the option you chose from the What to Stabilize pop-up menu.

- If you chose White Balance and Brightness, then you'll have a Normalized White Balance color control, and Low Level and High Level sliders.
- If you chose R, G, B Channels Separately, then you'll have Red, Green, and Blue High and Low Level sliders.

Contrast Pop (Studio Version Only)

A more extreme and selective version of the Midtone Detail control found in the Color Wheels palette, designed to add either sharp high-contrast looks, or soft low-contrast looks to a selective portion of the tonal range of the image.

- **Detail Amount:** Lets you choose how much of this effect to apply. At 0, no effect is applied. At positive values progressively sharper contrast is added, while at negative values progressively softer low-contrast is applied.
- **Detail size:** Lets you choose which structures of the image are affected by this localized contrast adjustment, from smaller to larger.
- **Low and High Threshold:** These values let you define what range of image tonality is affected by this filter, allowing you to omit either shadows or highlights from this operation.
- **Softness:** Lets you soften the transition between the affected and unaffected areas of the image.

DCTL (Studio Version Only)

Lets you apply a DCTL wherever you can apply ResolveFX plugins.

For more information on DCTLs and where they're installed, see *Chapter 200, "Creating DCTL LUTs."*

- **DCTL List:** A pop-up that lets you choose from the available DCTLs installed on your workstation location.
On Mac OS X: Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/LUT/
On Windows: C:\ProgramData\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\LUT
On Linux: /home/resolve/LUT
- **Reload DCTL:** Allows users to refresh the currently loaded DCTL file content. This lets the user make changes in the DCTL using a text editor, then reload it to see the results. It does not refresh the DCTL list; to do so, you must restart the DaVinci Resolve application.

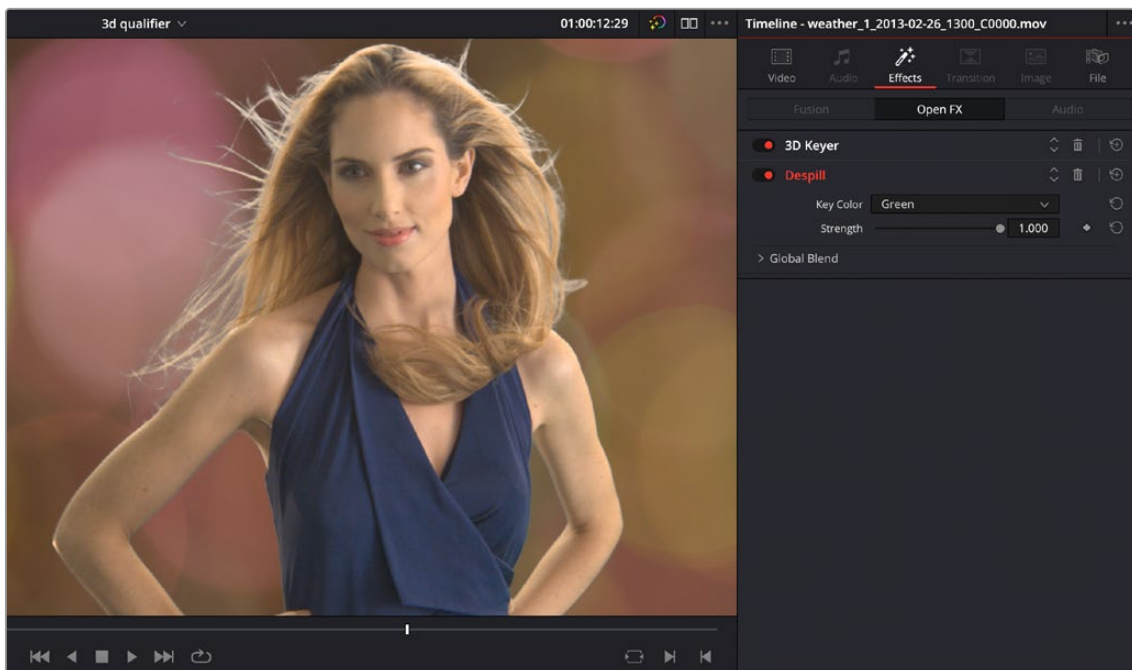
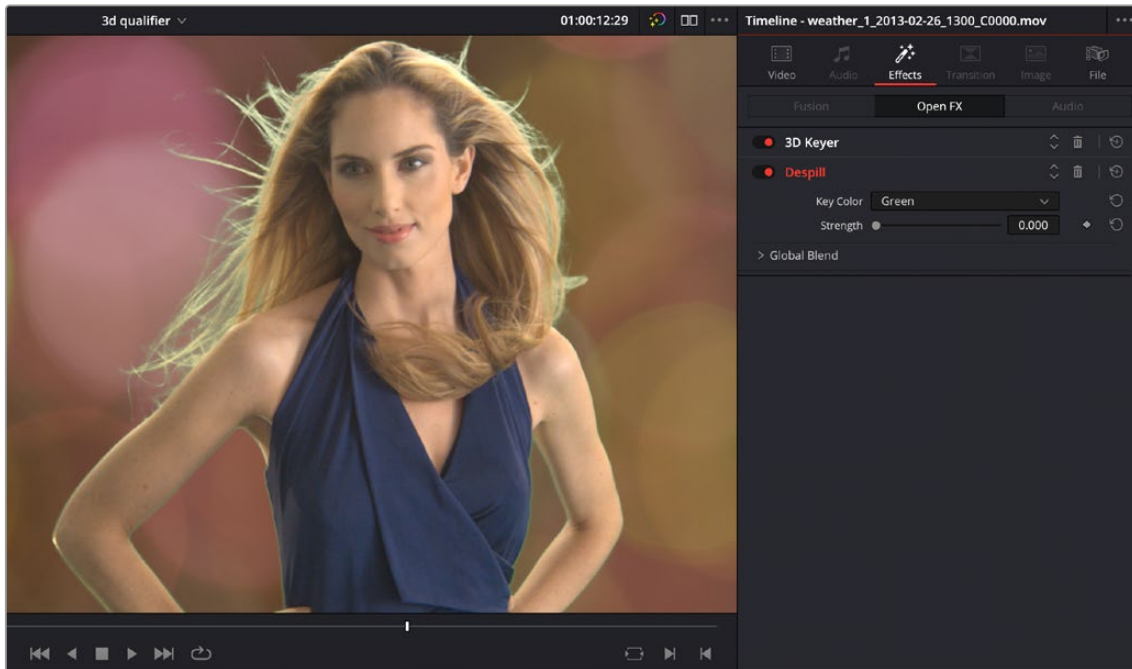
Dehaze (Studio Version Only)

Designed to let you make adjustments to color and contrast to reduce the visible effects of Aerial Perspective (i.e., smog, airlight, and haze) in an image. This filter automatically generates a simulated depth map, which is used to apply more of this corrective color adjustment to faraway parts of the image that would be more affected by haze effects and less color adjustment to closeup parts of the image. It estimates haze and has options for guiding that estimate and controlling the processing.

- **Dehaze Strength:** This slider applies a simultaneous color and contrast adjustment. Raising Dehaze Strength subtly increases contrast (especially in the shadows) while rebalancing color toward the complement of the currently selected Haze Color and selectively intensifying saturation. Lowering Dehaze Strength decreases contrast and rebalances color toward the selected Haze Color itself while selectively lowering saturation.
- **Haze Color:** A color control that lets you choose or sample the color of smog, airlight, or haze in an image that you want to minimize.
- **Display Depth:** Lets you view the simulated depth matte that's being generated. Turn this on before adjusting the Shadow and Highlight controls below.
- **Shadow:** This slider raises or lowers darkest parts of the simulated depth map that defines the parts of the image that are estimated to be farthest away.
- **Highlight:** This slider lets you raise or lower the lightest parts of the simulated depth map that defines the parts of the image that are estimated to be closest to us.

Despill

Removes the color cast on a subject caused by the reflection of light off the green or blue screen. This color cast can remain after the green screen has been keyed out. This Despill filter is useful for reducing spill after keying, or with externally generated keys or masks.



The Despill FX removing a green color cast from the subject's arms and hair. Above is no despill and below is full despill.

- **Key Color:** Sets the color to be removed from the subject, either Red, Green, or Blue.
- **Strength:** The amount of Despill to apply. 1.000 is equal to despill "on" in the previous version of the 3D Keyer checkbox. Variable strength comes in handy as you can preserve more of the original color information if the context allows it. For example, less despill is appropriate if the new composited background will also be green.

False Color (Studio Version Only)

False Color is designed to replicate exactly the false color readout of a Blackmagic Design camera but can also be used as a creative effect that can be used for replicating camera HUDs, infrared sensors, and custom posterization looks by remapping pixel brightness to customizable color bands and gradients. The color set can either match the False Color setting in a specific Blackmagic Design camera or be customized with a list of creative style presets provided for use or inspiration. The presets can be modified by setting the number of colors used and defining the tonal range each color represents.



Resolve FX False Color Camera preset and legend



Resolve FX False Color thermal creative preset and legend

General

- **Plugin Mode:** This menu is used to switch between matching a specific Blackmagic Design Camera's False Color setting or accessing creative presets. When Specific Camera Model is chosen, the Camera Model section is displayed for selecting the camera and settings you want to use. When Creative is chosen, the Color bands section is displayed for choosing and customizing the preset.

Camera Model

The Camera Model controls are displayed when Specific Camera Model is chosen from the Plugin Model menu. These menus allow you to match the False Color from a camera configuration.

- **Camera:** Selects the exact Blackmagic Design camera sensor.
- **Camera Mode:** Selects the dynamic range setting.
- **ISO Level:** Sets the ISO or light sensitivity setting.

Color Bands

These controls are displayed when Creative is chosen from the Plugin Model menu. The Color Bands group of controls are used to select and modify the appearance of the False Color presets.

- **Creative Style:** Selects one of the built-in style presets for the effect.
- **Number of Bands:** Lets you choose how many different colors are in the scale.
- **Show Sliders:** Exposes the Top and Bottom controls letting you select the specific range of a color in percentage values. For example, setting a Red color value between Bottom 45 and Top 55 will tint red anything in the image between 45 and 55% brightness on the waveform monitor.
- **Color:** Provides either a color swatch or picker to choose the color for the band.

Preprocessing

This group of controls is used to apply tonal and blur processing to the image.

- **Blur:** Applies a blur filter to the image before analysis.
- **Black Level:** Increases or decreases the shadow range assigned to colors that fall lower on the False Color legend.
- **White Level:** Increases or decreases the highlight range assigned to colors that fall higher on the False Color legend.
- **Gamma:** Shifts the mid-tone range towards colors that fall lower or higher on the False Color legend.

Scale/Legend

This section is used to control the visibility and appearance of the False Color legend shown at the left of the frame. The Legend shows how dark to light inputs get mapped to new colors. It is burned in to the image.

- **Show Scale:** Shows or hides the Legend.
- **Show Values:** Shows or hides numeric values on the Legend. These numeric values represent different scales based on the Value Style menu.
- **Show Labels:** Shows or hides data point labels on the Legend. The labels identify important data points along the tonal range, such as black clipping, white clipping, and middle gray.
- **Contrast:** Increases or decreases the transparency of the Legend's background underlay.
- **Value Detail:** Increases or decreases the number of axis value labels displayed on the Legend.
- **Value Style:** This menu includes three options for the scale used for the Legend's numeric values.

Percentage: Uses a percentage scale for the Legend, going from 0% at the bottom to 100% at the top.

Hundredths: Uses a Hundredths scale for the Legend, going from 0 at the bottom to 100 at the top with no “%” symbol.

Normalized: Uses a Normalized scale for the Legend, going from 0.0 at the bottom to 1.0 at the top.

Gamut Limiter

Lets you limit the gamut to a specified standard. Useful in situations where the delivery color space is a large gamut such as Rec. 2020, but the QC specification requires limiting to a smaller gamut such as P3, in order to limit the amount of saturation allowable in the final output. This is a limiting operation, so out of bounds values are hard clipped. This plugin can be used regardless of whether or not Resolve Color Management is enabled. Because it's a limiter, it should probably be one of the last operations in any node tree to prevent useful image data from being clipped.

- **Current Gamut:** Choose the timeline gamut currently being used by the image.
- **Current Gamma:** Choose the timeline gamma currently being used by the image.
- **Limit Gamma to:** Choose the gamut you want to restrict the image to here.

These menus present the same options as the Resolve Color Management menus in the Color Management panel.

For more information about the options available in these parameters, see *Chapter 9, "Data Levels, Color Management, and ACES."*

Gamut Mapping (Studio Version Only)

The Color Space Transform plugin provides Gamut Mapping controls to accommodate workflows where you need to transform one color space into another that has a dramatically larger or smaller gamut. These controls are identical to those found in the Color Space Transform plugin's Gamut Mapping group and are similar to those found in the Color Management panel of the Project Settings.

- **Gamma:** A pop-up menu lets you specify what type of gamma the clip is supposed to have, so set this to whatever matches that image (this may match the timeline color space, but it depends on how you're working).
- **Tone Mapping Method:** Lets you enable tone mapping, to accommodate workflows where you need to transform one color space into another with a dramatically larger or smaller dynamic range by automating an expansion or contraction of image contrast in such a way as to give a pleasing result with no clipping.

None: This setting disables Input DRT Tone Mapping. No tone mapping is applied to the Input to Timeline Color Space conversion at all, resulting in a simple 1:1 mapping to the Timeline Color Space.

Clip: Hard clips all out-of-bounds values.

Simple: Uses a simple curve to perform this transformation, compressing or expanding the highlights and/or shadows of the timeline dynamic range to better fit the output dynamic range. Note that the "Simple" option maps between approximately 5500 nits and 100 nits, so if you're mapping from an HDR source with more than 5500 nits to an SDR destination there may still be some clipping of the highlights above 5500 nits.

Luminance Mapping: Same as DaVinci, but more accurate when the Input Color Space of all your media is in a single standards-based color space, such as Rec. 709 or Rec. 2020.

DaVinci: This option tone maps the transform with a smooth luminance roll-off in the shadows and highlights, and controlled desaturation of image values in the very brightest and darkest parts of the image. This setting is particularly useful for wide-gamut camera media and is a good setting to use when mixing media from different cameras.

Saturation Preserving: This option has a smooth luminance roll-off in the shadows and highlights, but does so without desaturating dark shadows and bright highlights, so this is an effective option for colorists who like to push color harder. However, because over-saturation in the highlights of the image can look unnatural, two parameters are exposed to provide some user-adjustable automated desaturation.

- **Sat. Rolloff Start:** Lets you set a threshold, in nits (cd/m²), at which saturation will roll off along with highlight luminance. Beginning of the rolloff.
- **Sat. Rolloff Limit:** Lets you set a threshold, in nits (cd/m²), at which the image will be totally desaturated. End of the rolloff.

Max Input/Output Luminance: Checking these boxes and adjusting the slider below allows you to specify the minimum and maximum luminance of the input image in nits. Using these two sliders together, you can set which value from the Input Gamma is mapped to which value of the Output Gamma.

Avg. Input Luminance: Used to compensate for large differences in the viewer's state of visual adaptation when viewing a bright image on an HDR display versus seeing that same image on an SDR display. For most "average" images this setting works best set between 0–10. However, when you're converting very bright images (for example, a snow scene at noon), then using a higher value will yield more image detail within the highlights.

- **Gamut Mapping Method:** Accommodates workflows where you need to transform one color space into another with a dramatically larger or smaller gamut by helping to automate an expansion or contraction of image saturation in such a way as to give a pleasing and naturalistic result with no clipping. Choosing Saturation Mapping lets you remap the saturation values of the image. It enables the Saturation Knee and Saturation Max. controls.
 - The Saturation Knee slider sets the image level at which saturation mapping begins. Below this level, no remapping is applied. All saturation values from this level on up are remapped according to the Saturation Max. slider. A value of 1.0 is maximum saturation in the currently selected output color space.
 - The Saturation Max slider sets the new maximum level to which you want to either raise or lower all saturation values that are above the Saturation Knee setting. A value of 1.0 is maximum saturation in the currently selected output color space.
- **Apply Forward OOTF:** Check this box to convert the image from scene referred to display referred color management.
- **Apply Inverse OOTF:** Check this box to convert the image from display referred to scene referred color management.

Invert Color

A Color category plugin that lets you invert any color channel, including the Alpha channel just by checking the appropriate box. This little plugin has 101 uses in advanced workflows, especially when you need to invert Alpha or Key channels to do something specific. This is not a "film negative" plugin; this is a simple inversion.